🏛️ The "Easy Guide" to Roman History (Act 1, Scene 1) 🏛️

Before you read Line 1, you must understand the "Drama" happening in Rome. It's like a massive political soap opera! 🎭📺

1. The Two Big Names: Caesar vs. Pompey ⚔️

- **The Backstory:** Rome used to be ruled by three powerful men (including Caesar and a guy named Pompey). They were friends... until they weren't. 🤝➡️🚫
- **The Civil War:** They fought a huge war against each other. Caesar won! 🏆
- **The Problem in Scene 1:** Caesar is returning to Rome after defeating **Pompey's sons**. Usually, Romans celebrate when they defeat *foreign* enemies. But Caesar just killed *other Romans*. IT⚔️IT
- **The Crowd:** They don't care! They love a winner and they want a holiday. 🥳
- **The Tribunes:** They loved Pompey. They think the crowd is being "disloyal" and "fake" by celebrating the man who killed their old hero. 💔

2. The Feast of Lupercal 🏮🏃

- **What is it?:** An ancient Roman festival held on February 15th. It was a day of "fertility" and "cleansing."
- **The Vibe:** People would run through the streets, and it was a very festive, religious, and slightly crazy day. 🎊
- **Why it matters:** Caesar is timing his "Victory Parade" (his Triumph) on the same day as this holy festival. The Tribunes think he is trying to act like a God or a King. 👑🤴

3. The Tribunes (Flavius & Marullus) 👮‍♂️👮‍♂️

- **Their Job:** They are elected officials who are supposed to "protect the common people." 🛡️
- **The Reality:** In this scene, they act like angry cops. They hate Caesar because they are afraid he will become a **Dictator**. 🛑

- **The Goal:** They want to "pluck the feathers" from Caesar's wing (which means they want to take away his popularity) so he doesn't fly too high and become a King. 🪶✂️

4. The Class Gap 🛠️🎩

- **Working Class (Prose):** The Carpenter and Cobbler speak in normal, "common" English. They like jokes and puns. 👞🤡
- **The Elite (Blank Verse):** Flavius and Marullus speak in "Poetry" (iambic pentameter). They think they are smarter and better than the workers. 📖✨

Summary of the Conflict 💡

The workers want to **party** for Caesar. The officials want them to go home and **cry** for Pompey. It's a clash between the "New Power" (Caesar) and the "Old Power" (The Republic). 🏛️💥

LINE 1

Original Text: *Hence! home, you idle creatures, get you home:*

- **Translation:** "Get out of here! Go home, you lazy things, go back to your houses right now!" 🏃‍♂️🏠
- **Phrase-by-Phrase Meaning:**
    - **"Hence!":** A violent, one-word command. It's like a slap in the face. It means "Go away from this spot immediately." 🖐️💥
    - **"idle creatures":** **Idle** means lazy or unemployed. **Creatures** is the most important word—he isn't calling them "men" or "citizens"; he is calling them "animals" or "objects." 🐾🚫
    - **"get you home":** A repetitive command to show his authority. He wants the streets empty.
- **Total Meaning:** Flavius is screaming at the crowd to stop loitering and get off the streets because he finds their presence offensive. 😤
- **Deep Meaning:** This line establishes the **Class Conflict**. Flavius represents the "Elite" who look down on the "Commoners." By calling them "creatures," he shows that the government in Rome doesn't respect the

people—it only wants to control them. It also shows the **Tension**; the officials are terrified that if the people gather, they will support Caesar. 👮‍♂️🛡️

LINE 2

Original Text: *Is this a holiday? what! know you not,*

- **Translation:** "Is today a day off? What! Don't you know the rules?" 🗓️❓
- **Phrase-by-Phrase Meaning:**
    - **"Is this a holiday?":** This is deep sarcasm. Flavius knows exactly what day it is, but he's mocking them for acting like it's a vacation. 🙄
    - **"what!":** An exclamation of shock and anger.
    - **"know you not":** "Are you so ignorant that you don't know the law?"
- **Total Meaning:** He is questioning why they aren't at work and acting like they've forgotten their responsibilities. 🛠️🚫
- **Deep Meaning:** This represents the **Clash of Calendars**. The people see this as a day of "Triumph" (Caesar's victory), but the officials refuse to recognize it. It's a battle over what the city should "feel" like—celebration or strictly business. 🏛️⚖️

LINE 3

Original Text: *Being mechanical, you ought not walk*

- **Translation:** "Since you are manual laborers, you have no right to be walking around..." 🛠️👣
- **Phrase-by-Phrase Meaning:**
    - **"Being mechanical":** In Shakespeare's time, "mechanical" meant "working with your hands." It was an insult used by rich people to describe those they thought were uneducated. 🔧👷
    - **"you ought not walk":** "You are not allowed to stroll for pleasure."

- **Total Meaning:** He is telling them that their social class (being workers) means they don't have the freedom to just wander around during the day. 🚧
- **Deep Meaning:** This shows **Dehumanization**. To Flavius, these men are just "parts of a machine" (mechanical). They aren't humans with feelings or a desire for joy; they are just tools that should be kept in a shed until needed. It's a very cold, "Totalitarian" way of thinking. 🤖🏗️

LINE 4

Original Text: *Upon a labouring day without the sign*

- **Translation:** "...on a workday without carrying the symbols..." ⚒️👔
- **Phrase-by-Phrase Meaning:**
  - **"Upon a labouring day":** On a day meant for hard work (not a Sunday or a feast day).
  - **"without the sign":** Without your professional uniform or tools. 📏🔨
- **Total Meaning:** He is pointing out that they are breaking a specific Roman law: you must be identifiable by your trade when you are in public.
- **Deep Meaning:** This highlights **Surveillance and Identity**. In Rome, your clothes told everyone exactly who you were and where you belonged. By wearing their "best attire" (fancy clothes), the workers are hiding their class. This "anonymity" scares the officials because they can't control people they can't identify. 🕵️‍♂️🚫

LINE 5

Original Text: *Of your profession? Speak, what trade art thou?*

- **Translation:** "...of your job? Speak up! What is your craft?" 🎤💼
- **Phrase-by-Phrase Meaning:**

    - **"Of your profession?":** He is completing the thought from the previous line—where are the signs of your job?
    - **"Speak":** A direct, sharp order. 🗣️
    - **"what trade art thou?":** "What is your specific job?" (Using "thou" is a way of talking down to someone, like they are a child).
- **Total Meaning:** He interrogates a specific man, demanding to know his occupation to prove he is "out of place." 🧐
- **Deep Meaning:** This is a **"Show me your papers"** moment. Flavius is using his power to intimidate an individual. He doesn't want to know the man's name or his story; he only wants to know his "Trade." It reduces a human being to their "utility" (what they can build or fix). 👣🏛️

This is the **"Roman Conquest"** strategy in full effect! 🏛️⚔️ We are going to treat every speech like a secret code that needs to be cracked.

I. Shakespearean Vocabulary Table (Lines 1-5) 📖👞

Shakespearean Word	Modern Literal Meaning	Contextual Use in Scene 1
Hence	Go away from here	A harsh command to clear the street. 🏃‍♂️💨
Idle	Lazy / Unproductive	An insult to the workers' work ethic. 😴
Creatures	Animals / Things	Dehumanizing the workers to show low status. 🐾

Shakespearean Word	Modern Literal Meaning	Contextual Use in Scene 1
Mechanical	Manual Laborers	Referring to people who work with their hands. 🛠️
Ought	Should	Telling them they have a moral duty to work. ⚖️
Labouring Day	Workday	A day where the law requires you to work. ⚒️
Sign	Symbol / Uniform	The tools or clothes that prove your job. 📏
Thou / Art	You / Are	Used to talk "down" to social subordinates. 🎤

II. The Breakdown: Lines 6 - 9 🧩

LINE 6

Original Text: *First Commoner: Why, sir, a carpenter.*

- **Translation:** "Well, sir, I am a woodworker/carpenter." 🪚
- **Phrase-by-Phrase Meaning:**

    - **"Why, sir,":** A common opening phrase back then, like saying "Well..." or "To answer your question..."
    - **"a carpenter":** He states his profession clearly and honestly. 🏠
- **Total Meaning:** The first worker identifies himself by his job, hoping that his honesty will satisfy the angry official.
- **Deep Meaning:** This shows the **Simplicity vs. Arrogance**. The Carpenter is being direct and polite, while Flavius was being loud and insulting. It highlights that the workers aren't trying to start a fight; they just want to enjoy their day. However, by admitting he is a carpenter, he confirms he is "mechanical," giving the Tribunes more "ammo" to yell at him. 🛠️⚖️

LINE 7

Original Text: *MARULLUS: Where is thy leather apron and thy rule?*

- **Translation:** "Where is your protective work apron and your measuring stick?" 📏🧤
- **Phrase-by-Phrase Meaning:**
    - **"Where is thy...":** A demand for proof.
    - **"leather apron":** The standard uniform for a carpenter to protect his clothes.
    - **"thy rule":** The "ruler" or measuring tool used for precision in woodwork.
- **Total Meaning:** Marullus is interrogating the man like a suspect, looking for the physical tools that prove he is a carpenter. 👮‍♂️🔍
- **Deep Meaning:** This represents **The Uniform of Class**. In Rome, if you didn't have your tools, you weren't "properly" a worker in the eyes of the law. Marullus is trying to prove that the Carpenter is "out of uniform," which makes his presence in the street illegal on a workday. It shows how the state controls even the clothes people wear. 📜👔

LINE 8

Original Text: *MARULLUS: What dost thou with thy best apparel on?*

- **Translation:** "Why are you wearing your fancy Sunday clothes right now?" 🕺✨
- **Phrase-by-Phrase Meaning:**
    - **"What dost thou...":** "What are you doing..."
    - **"thy best apparel":** Your most expensive, non-work clothes.
- **Total Meaning:** He is asking why a manual laborer is dressed up as if he were a rich man or a nobleman on a holiday.
- **Deep Meaning:** This highlights **Social Disruption**. When commoners wear "best apparel," they look like the upper class. This scares the Tribunes because it blurs the lines between "the bosses" and "the workers." By dressing up for Caesar, the people are acting like they are "important," and Marullus hates that. 🎩🚫👞

LINE 9

Original Text: *MARULLUS: You, sir, what trade are you?*

- **Translation:** "And you, sir, what is your job?" 🎤🧐
- **Phrase-by-Phrase Meaning:**
    - **"You, sir,":** He turns his attention to the second man in the crowd.
    - **"what trade are you?":** "What is your specific craft?"
- **Total Meaning:** Marullus stops bullying the Carpenter for a moment to interrogate the next person (the Cobbler).
- **Deep Meaning:** This shows **Interrogation Tactics**. The Tribunes are trying to intimidate the whole group by picking them off one by one. This sets the stage for the **Cobbler**, who is about to use "wordplay" to make Marullus look like a fool. 🤡🔪

Strategic Summary (Lines 6-9) 💡

- **The Power Dynamic:** The officials (Marullus and Flavius) are acting like a "tag-team." One shouts, and the other interrogates. 👥💢
- **The "Sign" of Trouble:** The fact that the workers are in "best apparel" is the main reason the officials are so mad. It proves the workers have prioritized **Caesar's party** over their **Daily Duty**. ⚔️👑

I. Shakespearean Vocabulary Master Table (Lines 10-17) 📖🔪

Shakespearean Word	**Modern Literal Meaning**	**Contextual Use in Scene 1**
Truly	Honestly / In truth	Used as a filler word to make the speaker sound humble and polite.
In respect of	Compared to / In relation to	Setting up a comparison between his work and "finer" trades.
Fine workman	A master craftsman	Someone who does "superior" work, like building temples.
But	Only / Just	Used to downplay his own importance (ironically).
Cobbler	1. Shoemaker 2. A clumsy bungler	A pun used to confuse Marullus about his skill level.

Shakespearean Word	Modern Literal Meaning	Contextual Use in Scene 1
Directly	Straightforwardly / No jokes	A command to stop using wordplay and give a plain answer. 👮‍♂️
Conscience	Moral sense of right and wrong	He claims his job is "clean" and doesn't hurt his soul.
Mender	Repairer / Fixer	Someone who makes old things new again. ✨
Soles / Souls	Shoe bottoms / Human spirits	The most famous pun in the scene—fixing shoes vs. fixing people.
Knave	A dishonest or low-class man	A common insult for a servant or commoner. 💢
Naughty	Worthless / Wicked	In Shakespeare's time, this was much harsher than today.
Beseech	Beg / Ask earnestly	Used to mock the official by acting "scared." 🤡

Shakespearean Word	Modern Literal Meaning	Contextual Use in Scene 1
Out	1. Angry 2. Worn-out (shoes)	A double-meaning word used to trip up Marullus.
Mend	To repair / To improve	To fix a shoe or to fix a person's behavior. 🛠️
Saucy fellow	Rude / Cheeky person	Marullus thinks the worker is being too bold and disrespectful. 😳

II. Detailed Phrase-by-Phrase Breakdown 🧩🏛️

LINE 10

Original Text: *Second Commoner: Truly, sir, in respect of a fine workman, I am but, as you would say, a cobbler.*

- **Translation:** "Honestly, sir, if you are talking about a master builder, I am only what you would call a clumsy shoemaker." 👞
- **Phrase-by-Phrase Meaning:**
    - **"Truly, sir,":** He opens with a polite, calm tone to keep the official listening.
    - **"in respect of a fine workman,":** He creates a comparison. He is saying, "I'm not a high-class architect or artist."
    - **"I am but...":** "I am only..." He is pretending to be very humble.
    - **"as you would say, a cobbler":** He uses the word **"cobbler,"** which in Rome meant two things: a shoemaker and a person who is bad at their job.

- **Total Meaning:** The worker tells Marullus his job but does it in a "slippery" way, using a word that makes him sound like an amateur. 🤡
- **Deep Meaning:** This is **Verbal Camouflage**. The Cobbler is using "False Humility." By making himself sound "unimportant," he is actually baiting the official into an argument he cannot win. It shows that the common people are witty and can use language to fight back against the bullying elite. 🧠🛡️

LINE 11

Original Text: *MARULLUS: But what trade art thou? answer me directly.*

- **Translation:** "I don't care about your stories! What is your specific job? Answer me straight without the games!" 😤
- **Phrase-by-Phrase Meaning:**
    - **"But what trade art thou?":** He repeats the question because he is confused by the word "cobbler."
    - **"answer me directly":** "Give me a literal, one-word answer. Stop the joking."
- **Total Meaning:** Marullus is losing his patience. He feels that the worker is not showing him the respect an official deserves. 👮‍♂️📉
- **Deep Meaning:** This represents **The Arrogance of Power**. Marullus expects everyone to be afraid of him. When the Cobbler isn't "direct," Marullus feels his authority is being challenged. He wants to categorize the man (Carpenter? Mason?) so he can control him.

LINE 12

Original Text: *Second Commoner: A trade, sir, that, I hope, I may use with a safe conscience; which is, indeed, sir, a mender of bad soles.*

- **Translation:** "It is a job, sir, that I hope I can do without feeling like a bad person; it is, truly, the job of fixing bad shoe-bottoms." 👞✨

- **Phrase-by-Phrase Meaning:**
    - **"A trade, sir, that, I hope, I may use":** He is still refusing to give a simple name for his job.
    - **"with a safe conscience;":** He suggests his work is morally clean, unlike the "dirty" politics of Rome.
    - **"which is, indeed, sir,":** "Which is, quite truly, sir..."
    - **"a mender of bad soles.": THE PUN.** To the ear, "soles" (shoes) and "souls" (human spirits) sound exactly the same.
- **Total Meaning:** He describes his work as "fixing bad souls/soles," which sounds like he is a priest or a doctor of the spirit.
- **Deep Meaning:** This is **Political Sarcasm**. By saying he mends "bad souls," he is subtly hinting that the **Tribunes** (Marullus and Flavius) have "bad souls" because they are being cruel to the people. He is mocking their morality while pretending to talk about leather. ⚖️ 🔥

LINE 13

Original Text: *MARULLUS: What trade, thou knave? thou naughty knave, what trade?*

- **Translation:** "What job, you worthless jerk? You wicked, low-class man, I asked you what your job is!" 💢
- **Phrase-by-Phrase Meaning:**
    - **"What trade, thou knave?":** He uses the insult **"knave"** to remind the man of his low social status.
    - **"thou naughty knave,":** In this time, "naughty" meant "good-for-nothing" or "evil."
    - **"what trade?":** He is now shouting the question in frustration.
- **Total Meaning:** Marullus is completely enraged. He is too angry to notice the pun, so he thinks the worker is just being stupid or defiant. 👮 🌋

- **Deep Meaning:** This shows **Class-Based Rage**. When an official cannot understand a commoner's wit, they usually turn to insults and shouting. Marullus is trying to "bark" the man into submission.

LINE 14

Original Text: *Second Commoner: Nay, I beseech you, sir, be not out with me: yet, if you be out, sir, I can mend you.*

- **Translation:** "Please, sir, I beg you, don't be angry with me; however, if your shoes have holes in them, I can fix you up." 🔪🛠️
- **Phrase-by-Phrase Meaning:**
    - **"Nay, I beseech you, sir,":** "No, I beg of you, sir..." (He is pretending to be frightened).
    - **"be not out with me:": PUN PART 1.** "Out" means "angry." He is saying "Don't be mad at me."
    - **"yet, if you be out, sir,": PUN PART 2.** "Out" also means "worn out" or having holes in the bottom of your shoes.
    - **"I can mend you.":** "I can repair you."
- **Total Meaning:** He uses the word "out" to play a trick. He says "Don't be mad, but if you are 'out' (wearing shoes with holes), I can fix you."
- **Deep Meaning:** This is a **Double Entendre**. He is offering to fix Marullus's shoes, but he is also saying that Marullus's *personality* is "broken" and needs to be "mended" (improved). It is a very bold insult disguised as a helpful offer. 😈👞

LINE 15

Original Text: *MARULLUS: What meanest thou by that? mend me, thou saucy fellow!*

- **Translation:** "What are you trying to say? Fix *me*? You disrespectful, cheeky man!" 😳💥

- **Phrase-by-Phrase Meaning:**
    - **"What meanest thou by that?":** Marullus is finally sensing that he is being insulted, but he isn't sure how.
    - **"mend me,":** He is offended by the idea that a "dirty" worker could "fix" a high-ranking official.
    - **"thou saucy fellow!":** "Saucy" means "full of attitude" or "disrespectful."
- **Total Meaning:** Marullus takes the word "mend" as a personal attack on his character and his social rank.
- **Deep Meaning:** This reveals the **Insecurity of the Elite**. Marullus is so obsessed with his "high status" that he finds the idea of a commoner "mending" him to be an impossible insult. He sees the worker as "saucy" because the worker isn't acting like a servant. 🏛️ 🚫

LINE 16

Original Text: *Second Commoner: Why, sir, cobble you.*

- **Translation:** "Well, sir, I just mean I would repair your shoes." 👞
- **Phrase-by-phrase Meaning:**
    - **"Why, sir,":** "Well, obviously, sir..."
    - **"cobble you.":** "I would repair your shoes." (But "cobble" also sounds like "beat someone up").
- **Total Meaning:** He "innocently" explains that he is just talking about shoe repair, making Marullus look even sillier for getting so angry.
- **Deep Meaning:** The Cobbler is **Gaslighting** the official. He makes a bold joke, waits for the official to get mad, and then pretends he was just talking about work. He makes the Tribune look "crazy" for taking it personally. 🤡 🎭

LINE 17

Original Text: *FLAVIUS: Thou art a cobbler, art thou?*

- **Translation:** "Oh, I see. You are a shoemaker, aren't you?" 🧐
- **Phrase-by-Phrase Meaning:**
    - **"Thou art a cobbler,":** "You are a shoemaker."
    - **"art thou?":** "Is that correct?"
- **Total Meaning:** Flavius finally understands the whole conversation. He realizes that the man has been talking about shoes the entire time.
- **Deep Meaning:** This shows **The Difference in Intelligence**. Flavius is much smarter and calmer than Marullus. While Marullus was screaming and getting insulted, Flavius was listening and finally solved the "riddle" of the Cobbler's trade. 👮‍♂️✅

I. Shakespearean Vocabulary Master Table (Lines 18-21)

Shakespearean Word	**Modern Literal Meaning**	**Contextual Use in Scene 1**
Awl	A pointed tool for piercing holes in leather	A pun on the word "all." He lives by his tool and his "all" (everything).
Meddle	To interfere or get involved	He claims he doesn't interfere in other people's business.

Shakespearean Word	Modern Literal Meaning	Contextual Use in Scene 1
Matters	Business, affairs, or topics	He claims he doesn't discuss politics or trade secrets.
Withal	Nevertheless / At the same time	A transition used to move to his next witty point.
Surgeon	A medical doctor	He uses this high-status title to describe his shoe-repair job.
Recover	1. To heal 2. To put a new leather cover on	A pun about "re-covering" shoes vs. "recovering" health.
Proper	Respectable or high-class	Refers to men of high social standing in Rome.
Trod	Walked or stepped on	Past tense of "tread."
Neat's leather	Leather made from cow/ox hide	"Neat" was an old English term for cattle.
Handiwork	Work done by hand	Refers to the shoes he has personally repaired.

Shakespearean Word	Modern Literal Meaning	Contextual Use in Scene 1
Wherefore	Why	Flavius is asking "Why are you not in your shop?"
Art / Dost / Thou	Are / Do / You	Informal/low-status address used by officials to subordinates.
Triumph	A victory parade / celebration	A massive Roman event celebrating a military conqueror.

II. Detailed Phrase-by-Phrase Breakdown

LINE 18

Original Text: *Second Commoner: Truly, sir, all that I live by is with the awl: I meddle with no tradesman's matters, nor women's matters, but withal I am, indeed, sir, a surgeon to old shoes; when they are in great danger, I recover them. As proper men as ever trod upon neat's leather have gone upon my handiwork.*

- **Phrase 1: "Truly, sir, all that I live by is with the awl:"**
    - **Translation:** "Honestly, sir, everything I do to survive is done using my leather-piercing tool."
    - **Detailed Meaning:** He explains that his entire livelihood—his money and his daily life—comes from using his **awl**.
    - **Deep Meaning: The Pun.** It sounds like "all that I live by is with the *all*," meaning he is a complete man of his trade. It shows his wit in making his simple life sound philosophically deep to the officials.
- **Phrase 2: "I meddle with no tradesman's matters,"**

    - **Translation:** "I don't interfere with the business of other workers,"
    - **Detailed Meaning:** He is saying he minds his own business and doesn't get involved in the secrets or affairs of other craftsmen.
    - **Deep Meaning:** This is a subtle insult to the Tribunes. The Tribunes *are* meddling in the business of the commoners right now. He is telling them to stop interfering with his holiday.
- **Phrase 3: "nor women's matters,"**
    - **Translation:** "...and I don't get involved in women's business or gossip,"
    - **Detailed Meaning:** He claims he stays away from social gossip or things outside of his masculine trade.
    - **Deep Meaning:** This is a "saucy" joke. In Shakespeare's time, this could have a slightly rude double meaning. He is using humor to keep the officials off-balance.
- **Phrase 4: "but withal I am, indeed, sir, a surgeon to old shoes;"**
    - **Translation:** "...but in addition, I am truly a doctor for worn-out shoes;"
    - **Detailed Meaning:** He uses the metaphor of a **surgeon**. Just as a doctor fixes a human body, he "operates" on leather to fix it.
    - **Deep Meaning: Class Satire.** A surgeon is an educated, high-class professional. By comparing his lowly job to a surgeon's, he is mocking the Tribunes' love of fancy titles and high status.
- **Phrase 5: "when they are in great danger, I recover them."**
    - **Translation:** "When shoes are in a terrible state and about to fall apart, I save/fix them."
    - **Detailed Meaning:** He says he rescues shoes that are near "death" (too worn out to wear).

    - **Deep Meaning: The Pun.** "Recover" means to make a patient healthy, but to a shoemaker, it means "re-covering" the shoe with new leather. He is playing with medical language to stay funny.
- **Phrase 6: "As proper men as ever trod upon neat's leather"**
    - **Translation:** "The most respectable and high-class men who have ever walked in cowhide shoes..."
    - **Detailed Meaning:** He is talking about the most important noblemen and leaders of Rome.
    - **Deep Meaning:** He is reminding the Tribunes that even the highest people in the city rely on "neat's leather" (shoes). He is proving that everyone, no matter how rich, needs a cobbler.
- **Phrase 7: "have gone upon my handiwork."**
    - **Translation:** "...have walked around on the very things I have made/fixed with my hands."
    - **Detailed Meaning:** The most important men in Rome use my services and walk on my work.
    - **Deep Meaning:** This is a "mic drop" moment. He is telling the Tribunes that they might be yelling at him, but his work is respected by their own social equals. He is asserting his importance.
- **Total Meaning of Line 18:** The Cobbler gives a long, clever speech explaining that he is a simple man who minds his business, yet his skills are so great that he acts as a "surgeon" to shoes, serving the most important men in Rome.

LINE 19 & 20

Original Text: *FLAVIUS: But wherefore art not in thy shop today? Why dost thou lead these men about the streets?*

- **Phrase 1: "But wherefore art not in thy shop today?"**
    - **Translation:** "But why aren't you in your workshop working today?"

    - **Detailed Meaning:** Flavius ignores the jokes and asks a direct question: If you are such a great worker, why are you out here?
    - **Deep Meaning:** Flavius is trying to regain control. He wants to stop the jokes and get back to the "illegal" nature of the gathering. He is frustrated that the worker isn't acting "mechanical" by staying inside and working.
- **Phrase 2: "Why dost thou lead these men about the streets?"**
    - **Translation:** "Why are you leading this whole crowd through the public roads?"
    - **Detailed Meaning:** He asks why the Cobbler is acting like a leader of a parade or a protest.
    - **Deep Meaning:** This shows **Political Fear**. The Tribunes are terrified of a "mob." If one worker is leading a group, it looks like a rebellion. They are afraid the crowd is gathering for Caesar.
- **Total Meaning of Lines 19-20:** Flavius demands to know why the Cobbler is neglecting his job and why he is acting as a leader for a large group of people in public.

LINE 21

Original Text: *Second Commoner: Truly, sir, to wear out their shoes, to get myself into more work. But, indeed, sir, we make holiday, to see Caesar and to rejoice in his triumph.*

- **Phrase 1: "Truly, sir, to wear out their shoes, to get myself into more work."**
    - **Translation:** "Honestly, sir, I'm making them walk so they ruin their shoes, and then they'll have to pay me to fix them."
    - **Detailed Meaning:** He makes a joke saying that he is leading the crowd purely for business—to create more broken shoes for him to repair.

    - **Deep Meaning:** This is more **Sarcasm**. He is pretending that he is a greedy businessman. He is teasing the Tribunes because he knows they won't believe this answer.

- **Phrase 2: "But, indeed, sir, we make holiday,"**
    - **Translation:** "But actually, sir, we are taking a day off,"
    - **Detailed Meaning:** He finally stops the jokes and gives the real reason for their presence.
    - **Deep Meaning:** By saying "we make holiday," he is claiming the right of the people to celebrate, even if the officials don't like it.
- **Phrase 3: "to see Caesar and to rejoice in his triumph."**
    - **Translation:** "...to catch a glimpse of Caesar and to celebrate his victory parade."
    - **Detailed Meaning:** We are here for Caesar. We want to be part of his great celebration.
    - **Deep Meaning: THE CORE CONFLICT.** This is the first time Caesar's name is mentioned in the play. It is the moment the "comedy" stops and the "politics" begins. The workers are openly admitting they support the man the Tribunes hate. This sets off Marullus's famous angry speech that follows.
- **Total Meaning of Line 21:** The Cobbler makes one last joke about making money from broken shoes, but then admits the truth: they are all in the streets to welcome Caesar and celebrate his military victory.

I. Shakespearean Vocabulary Master Table (Lines 22-37) 📖🏛️

Shakespearean Word	**Modern Literal Meaning**	**Contextual Use in Scene 1**
Wherefore	Why	Marullus asks why they are celebrating. ❓

Shakespearean Word	Modern Literal Meaning	Contextual Use in Scene 1
Conquest	Military victory	Referring to Caesar's defeat of Pompey's sons. ⚔️
Tributaries	Captured kings/nations who pay money	Foreigners brought back as slaves/tax-payers. 💰⛓️
Captive bonds	Chains of a prisoner	The state of being a prisoner of war. ⛓️
Senseless	Lacking feelings or intelligence	He calls the crowd "stupid" and "unfeeling." 🧠🚫
Oft	Often	Referring to how many times they cheered for Pompey.
Battlements	Protective walls on top of a castle/fort	High places where people climbed to see. 🏰
Yea	Even / Indeed	Used to emphasize the height people climbed.
Expectation	Waiting with excitement	The feeling of waiting for a hero to arrive. ⏳✨

Shakespearean Word	Modern Literal Meaning	Contextual Use in Scene 1
Universal	All together / Massive	A shout that everyone joined in on. 🗣️🌍
Tiber	The main river in Rome	The river that runs through the city. 🌊
Replication	Echo / Copy of a sound	The sound of the shout bouncing off the riverbanks. 📢🌀
Concave	Curved inward	The hollowed-out shape of the riverbanks. 🌊🌙

II. Detailed Phrase-by-Phrase Breakdown 🧩

LINE 22

Original Text: *MARULLUS: Wherefore rejoice? What conquest brings he home?*

- **Phrase 1: "Wherefore rejoice?"**
  - **Translation:** "Why are you celebrating?" 🤔
  - **Detailed Meaning:** Marullus is demanding a reason for their happiness.
  - **Deep Meaning:** He is challenging their loyalty. He believes there is nothing good to celebrate about Caesar's return. 🛑
- **Phrase 2: "What conquest brings he home?"**

- **Translation:** "What great victory is he bringing back to Rome?" ⚔️🏠
- **Detailed Meaning:** He is asking what territory or enemy Caesar has actually defeated for the benefit of Rome.
- **Deep Meaning:** This is a stinging insult. Caesar didn't defeat a foreign enemy (like the Gauls); he defeated the sons of Pompey—fellow Romans. Marullus is saying this isn't a "conquest," it's a murder of their own people. ɪt 🩸

LINE 23

Original Text: *What tributaries follow him to Rome,*

- **Translation:** "Which captured kings are following his chariot to pay us taxes?" 💰⛓️
- **Detailed Meaning:** In a real Roman "Triumph" (parade), the winner brought back foreign kings to show off his power.
- **Deep Meaning:** Marullus is pointing out that Caesar's parade is "empty" of real glory because he hasn't brought back new wealth or new lands for Rome. 🏛️🕳️

LINE 24

Original Text: *To grace in captive bonds his chariot-wheels?*

- **Translation:** "...to decorate his chariot wheels while tied up in chains?" ⛓️🎡
- **Detailed Meaning:** He refers to the tradition of dragging prisoners behind the general's carriage.
- **Deep Meaning:** He is mocking the "decoration" of the parade. He thinks it is shameful to celebrate a victory that didn't expand the Roman Empire but instead hurt Roman families. 🏛️🚫

LINE 25

Original Text: *You blocks, you stones, you worse than senseless things!*

- **Phrase 1: "You blocks, you stones,"**
    - **Translation:** "You are as stupid as blocks of wood and pieces of rock!" 🧱🪨
    - **Detailed Meaning:** He is calling the commoners inanimate objects that cannot think.
    - **Deep Meaning:** He is insulting their intelligence. He thinks they are too dumb to see that Caesar is a threat to their freedom. 🧠🚫
- **Phrase 2: "you worse than senseless things!"**
    - **Translation:** "You are even dumber than objects that have no brains!" 🪨
    - **Detailed Meaning:** Even a rock doesn't celebrate its own destruction, but these people are celebrating a potential dictator.
    - **Deep Meaning:** He is dehumanizing them again, just like Flavius did with the word "creatures." 🐾

LINE 26

Original Text: *O you hard hearts, you cruel men of Rome,*

- **Translation:** "Oh, you cold-hearted and mean people of this city," 🧊💔
- **Detailed Meaning:** He calls them "cruel" because they have forgotten their old hero, Pompey.
- **Deep Meaning:** He is attacking their emotions. He wants them to feel guilty for being "fake friends" who change their heroes every time a new one arrives. 🎭🐍

LINE 27

Original Text: *Knew you not Pompey? Many a time and oft*

- **Phrase 1: "Knew you not Pompey?"**
    - **Translation:** "Don't you remember Pompey?" ⚔️🤴
    - **Detailed Meaning:** He reminds them of the great general they used to love before Caesar killed him.
    - **Deep Meaning:** He is calling them hypocrites. He is saying, "Yesterday you loved Pompey, today you love his killer. You have no loyalty." 📉
- **Phrase 2: "Many a time and oft"**
    - **Translation:** "So many times and so very often," ⏳
    - **Detailed Meaning:** He is emphasizing how frequently they used to celebrate Pompey.

LINE 28

Original Text: *Have you climb'd up to walls and battlements,*

- **Translation:** "You used to climb up onto the city walls and high towers," 🏰🧗
- **Detailed Meaning:** He describes the physical effort people made to see Pompey's parades.
- **Deep Meaning:** He is painting a picture of their past passion to show how "disgusting" their current behavior is. 🖼️👎

LINE 29

Original Text: *To towers and windows, yea, to chimney-tops,*

- **Translation:** "...onto towers, windows, and even to the very tops of the chimneys," 🏢🏘️
- **Detailed Meaning:** People were so desperate to see Pompey that they climbed dangerously high. ⬆️

- **Deep Meaning:** This shows the "fever" and "madness" of the crowd's love for leaders. Marullus is saying they are easily manipulated by whoever is "winning." 🪁🤡

LINE 30

Original Text: *Your infants in your arms, and there have sat*

- **Translation:** "...holding your babies in your arms, and you sat there," 🤱👶
- **Detailed Meaning:** Even parents with small children waited in the heat and cold just to see Pompey.
- **Deep Meaning:** This adds an emotional layer. He is saying, "You even taught your children to love Pompey, and now you have betrayed him." 🍼💔

LINE 31

Original Text: *The live-long day, with patient expectation,*

- **Translation:** "...for the entire day, waiting with great excitement and patience," ⏳✨
- **Detailed Meaning:** They didn't mind the long wait because they loved Pompey so much.
- **Deep Meaning:** He is contrasting their "patience" for Pompey with their "holiday" for Caesar. He wants them to feel like traitors. 🥀🏛️

LINE 32

Original Text: *To see great Pompey pass the streets of Rome:*

- **Translation:** "...just to watch the great Pompey travel through the roads of the city." 🏛️👨‍🦲🚶
- **Detailed Meaning:** The only goal of their long wait was to see their hero.

- **Deep Meaning:** By calling him **"Great Pompey,"** Marullus is showing his own political bias. He still views Pompey as the true leader of Rome. 🎖️

LINE 33

Original Text: *And when you saw his chariot but appear,*

- **Translation:** "And the moment you saw even just the front of his carriage appearing," 🏎️👀
- **Detailed Meaning:** As soon as the parade came into view.
- **Deep Meaning:** He is building the tension in his speech to remind them of how "crazy" they used to go for Pompey. 📈🔥

LINE 34

Original Text: *Have you not made an universal shout,*

- **Translation:** "Didn't you all let out a massive, giant scream of joy together?" 🗣️🌍💥
- **Detailed Meaning:** A "universal shout" means every single person yelled at the same time.
- **Deep Meaning:** He is describing the "Power of the Crowd." He is reminding them that their voices have power, but they are using that power for the "wrong" person now. 🔊📢

LINE 35

Original Text: *That Tiber trembled underneath her banks,*

- **Translation:** "That the Tiber River literally shook beneath its own edges," 🌊😳
- **Detailed Meaning:** The shout was so loud that the water in the river vibrated.

- **Deep Meaning:** This is **Personification**. He describes the River Tiber as a "she" (her banks) who was terrified or moved by the loud noise. It shows the epic scale of their past loyalty. 🌊🏛️

LINE 36

Original Text: *To hear the replication of your sounds*

- **Translation:** "...when she heard the echo of your loud cheering," 🔊🌀
- **Detailed Meaning:** The sound was so massive it bounced back off the walls and the water.
- **Deep Meaning:** The "replication" (echo) shows that their love for Pompey filled the entire city. It wasn't just a small group; it was everyone. 🏛️🕰️

LINE 37

Original Text: *Made in her concave shores?*

- **Translation:** "...bouncing inside the hollow, curved-in banks of the river?" 🌊🌙
- **Detailed Meaning:** He uses the scientific word "concave" to describe the shape of the riverbank that helped the sound echo.
- **Deep Meaning:** This completes the visual and auditory picture of Rome's passion. Marullus is using "Poetry" (Blank Verse) to make his point sound beautiful and powerful, unlike the "prose" (normal talk) of the workers. 📖✨

Total Meaning of Lines 22-37: Marullus delivers a fierce, emotional speech to make the workers feel like ungrateful traitors. He reminds them of how much they used to love Pompey—climbing onto roofs and waiting all day just to cheer—and he shames them for now celebrating Caesar, the man who defeated Pompey's family. 🏛️🔥👺

I. Shakespearean Vocabulary Master Table (Lines 38-67) 📖🏛️

Shakespearean Word	Modern Literal Meaning	Contextual Use in Scene 1
Attire	Clothes / Outfit	Referring to the workers' fancy holiday clothing. 👗
Cull out	To pick out / Select	Choosing a specific day to make it a holiday. 🗓️
Strew	Scatter / Throw around	Throwing flowers on the path for a parade. 🌸
Intermit	To delay / Prevent / Stop	Asking the gods to stop a punishment from happening. 🛑
Plague	A disaster / Divine punishment	A curse sent by gods for being ungrateful. 😷⚡
Ingratitude	Thanklessness / Lack of loyalty	The "sin" of forgetting Pompey so quickly. 🌀
Basest metal	Lowest quality spirit / Character	Referring to the commoners' weak or "cheap" emotions. 🔩
Tongue-tied	Unable to speak / Silent	The workers leave without arguing because they feel guilty. 😶

Shakespearean Word	Modern Literal Meaning	Contextual Use in Scene 1
Disrobe	To strip / Uncover	Taking decorations off the statues of Caesar. 🏛️🚫
Ceremonies	Decorations / Trophies	Religious or honorary ornaments placed on statues. 🎗️
Lupercal	An ancient fertility festival	A major Roman holiday held on February 15th. 🏃‍♂️🏮
Vulgar	Common people / The masses	Not an insult here, just meaning the "lower class." 👥
Pitch	Height of a bird's flight	A metaphor for how much power Caesar has. 🦅
Servile	Like a slave / Submissive	Living in fear and obeying a master. ⛓️

II. Detailed Phrase-by-Phrase Breakdown 🧩IT

LINE 38

Original Text: *And do you now put on your best attire?*

- **Translation:** "And are you really wearing your best clothes right now?" 👔✨

- **Detailed Meaning:** Marullus is disgusted that they are dressed up to celebrate Pompey's enemy.
- **Deep Meaning:** He views their clothing as a physical symbol of their betrayal. Every clean shirt is an insult to Pompey's memory. 🏛️💔

LINE 39

Original Text: *And do you now cull out a holiday?*

- **Translation:** "And are you now choosing to make today a day off?" 🗓️
- **Detailed Meaning:** He questions why they decided to treat this specific day as a holy celebration.
- **Deep Meaning:** He implies that this is a "fake" holiday created by the crowd's whim, not a proper religious event. 🚫🎊

LINE 40

Original Text: *And do you now strew flowers in his way*

- **Translation:** "And are you now throwing flowers on the ground for him?" 🌸🏞️
- **Detailed Meaning:** Referring to the tradition of scattering blossoms before a returning hero.
- **Deep Meaning:** This represents total devotion. By throwing flowers, the people are treating Caesar like a god. 🛐

LINE 41

Original Text: *That comes in triumph over Pompey's blood?*

- **Translation:** "...for a man who is celebrating his victory over Pompey's own family?" 🩸⚔️
- **Detailed Meaning:** Caesar didn't defeat foreigners; he defeated the sons of Pompey (Romans).

- **Deep Meaning: THE GUILT TRIP.** Marullus is saying that Caesar's "Triumph" is built on the dead bodies of fellow Romans. It is "un-Roman" to celebrate a civil war victory. IT 💀

LINE 42 - 45

Original Text: *Be gone! Run to your houses, fall upon your knees, Pray to the gods to intermit the plague That needs must light on this ingratitude.*

- **Phrase 1: "Be gone! Run to your houses,"**
  - **Translation:** "Get out of here! Go home right now!" 🏃‍♂️🏠
  - **Detailed Meaning:** He orders the crowd to disperse.
- **Phrase 2: "fall upon your knees, Pray to the gods"**
  - **Translation:** "Kneel down and beg the gods for forgiveness," 🛐🙏
  - **Detailed Meaning:** He wants them to repent for their "sin" of disloyalty.
- **Phrase 3: "to intermit the plague / That needs must light on this ingratitude."**
  - **Translation:** "...to stop the disaster that is definitely coming because you are so ungrateful." 😷⚡
  - **Detailed Meaning:** He warns that the gods will punish Rome with a plague for being so "thankless" toward Pompey.
- **Total Meaning:** Leave the street, go home, and pray that the gods don't kill us all because of how disloyal you have been.
- **Deep Meaning:** Marullus uses **Religious Fear** to control the crowd. He suggests that their political choice (supporting Caesar) is actually a moral crime that will ruin the entire city. 🏛️🌪️

LINE 46 - 50

Original Text: *Go, go, good countrymen, and, for this fault, Assemble all the poor men of your sort; Draw them to Tiber banks, and weep your tears Into the channel, till the lowest stream Do kiss the most exalted shores of all.*

- **Phrase 1: "Assemble all the poor men of your sort;"**
    - **Translation:** "Gather all the other common workers like yourselves;" 👥
    - **Detailed Meaning:** Flavius takes over the speech and tells them to find more people.
- **Phrase 2: "Draw them to Tiber banks, and weep your tears / Into the channel,"**
    - **Translation:** "Take them to the edges of the Tiber River and cry into the water," 🌊😭
    - **Detailed Meaning:** He wants them to show extreme sadness.
- **Phrase 3: "till the lowest stream / Do kiss the most exalted shores of all."**
    - **Translation:** "...until the river rises from your tears and touches the highest parts of the banks." 🌊📈
    - **Detailed Meaning:** This is **Hyperbole** (extreme exaggeration).
- **Total Meaning:** Go find all the other workers and cry into the river until your tears cause a flood that reaches the highest ground.
- **Deep Meaning:** Flavius wants their "guilt" to be so massive that it changes nature. He is pushing them to feel a deep, overwhelming sorrow for their "betrayal" of the old Republic. 🏛️💧

LINE 51 - 53

Original Text: *See whether their basest metal be not moved; They vanish tongue-tied in their guiltiness.*

- **Phrase 1: "See whether their basest metal be not moved;"**

    - **Translation:** "Look and see if even their cheap, low spirits aren't affected by our words;" 🔩📉
    - **Detailed Meaning:** Flavius notes that the commoners look ashamed.
    - **Deep Meaning:** He uses a metal-working metaphor. "Basest metal" (like lead or iron) is easily melted. He is saying the commoners have "weak" souls that can be easily manipulated by a good speech. 🛡️🔥
- **Phrase 2: "They vanish tongue-tied in their guiltiness."**
    - **Translation:** "They are disappearing silently because they feel so guilty." 🤐🍽️
    - **Detailed Meaning:** The crowd leaves without saying a word.
- **Deep Meaning:** The "Comedy" of the Cobbler is over. The Tribunes have successfully used shame to silence the joy of the people. The people leave "tongue-tied," meaning the Tribunes have won this small battle. 🔇⚖️

LINE 54 - 56

Original Text: *Go you down that way towards the Capitol; This way will I: disrobe the images, If you do find them deck'd with ceremonies.*

- **Phrase 1: "Go you down that way towards the Capitol; This way will I:"**
    - **Translation:** "You go toward the center of government, and I will go this way;" 🏛️🚶
    - **Detailed Meaning:** They split up to cover more ground.
- **Phrase 2: "disrobe the images, If you do find them deck'd with ceremonies."**
    - **Translation:** "Strip the statues if you find them covered in decorations." 🏛️🚫🎗️
    - **Detailed Meaning:** They are going to tear down the flowers and trophies placed on Caesar's statues.

- **Deep Meaning:** This is an act of **Political Vandalism**. By "disrobing" the statues, they are trying to lower Caesar's status. They want to make it look like Rome doesn't love him as much as it seems. 🦹‍♂️✂️

LINE 57 - 58

Original Text: *MARULLUS: May we do so? You know it is the feast of Lupercal.*

- **Translation:** "Are we allowed to do that? You know it's the holy day of Lupercal." 🏮❓
- **Detailed Meaning:** Marullus is worried that touching statues during a religious festival might be illegal or unlucky.
- **Deep Meaning:** It shows that Marullus is more cautious and religious, while Flavius is more focused on political action. 🏛️⚖️

LINE 59 - 62

Original Text: *FLAVIUS: It is no matter; let no images Be hung with Caesar's trophies. I'll about, And drive away the vulgar from the streets: So do you too, where you perceive them thick.*

- **Phrase 1: "It is no matter; let no images / Be hung with Caesar's trophies."**
    - **Translation:** "It doesn't matter; don't let any statues be decorated with Caesar's symbols." 🏛️🚫
    - **Detailed Meaning:** Flavius ignores the religious risk to achieve his political goal.
- **Phrase 2: "And drive away the vulgar from the streets:"**
    - **Translation:** "And push the common people out of the public roads;" 👥🏃‍♂️
    - **Detailed Meaning:** He wants to prevent any more crowds from forming.

- **Deep Meaning:** He views the people ("the vulgar") as a "thick" substance that needs to be thinned out. He wants to isolate Caesar from his supporters. 🛡️🚫

LINE 63 - 66

Original Text: *These growing feathers pluck'd from Caesar's wing Will make him fly an ordinary pitch, Who else would soar above the view of men And keep us all in servile fearfulness.*

- **Phrase 1: "These growing feathers pluck'd from Caesar's wing"**
    - **Translation:** "By taking away these 'feathers' (the supporters and decorations) from Caesar's power," 🪶✂️
    - **Detailed Meaning:** A metaphor comparing Caesar to a bird of prey (a falcon or eagle).
- **Phrase 2: "Will make him fly an ordinary pitch,"**
    - **Translation:** "...it will make him fly at a normal height like everyone else," 🪶📉
    - **Detailed Meaning:** If they take away his popularity, he will just be a normal citizen, not a king.
- **Phrase 3: "Who else would soar above the view of men"**
    - **Translation:** "...otherwise, he will fly so high we can't even reach him," ☁️🤷‍♂️
- **Phrase 4: "And keep us all in servile fearfulness."**
    - **Translation:** "...and he will treat us all like slaves who live in fear." ⛓️😨
- **Total Meaning:** If we don't stop his popularity now by "plucking his feathers" (taking his supporters), he will become so powerful that he will turn into a dictator and make us his slaves.
- **Deep Meaning:** This is the **Climax of the Scene**. Flavius reveals the true motive: **Fear of Tyranny**. They aren't just mean "cops"; they are men who

believe they are saving the Republic from a man who wants to be a King. 🏛️🦅🚫👑

Strategic Summary (Lines 38-67): The scene ends with a shift from shaming the crowd to active political sabotage. The Tribunes plan to strip Caesar of his public honors and clear the streets. They believe that by "plucking" his popularity, they can prevent him from becoming a god-like dictator who would enslave Rome. 🏛️⚔️🛡️